

On the Ear

On the ear headphones rest on your ear and over the ear ones cover you ear completely. The difference between these two is vast, even through even though it might not be apparent at a glance. The audio quality of headphones largely depends on a few parameters; the audio drivers, the cushioning, noise isolation, ear muff seal and open/closed back. Now, while we wont dwell into factors such as audio drivers now, the other ones are very



On the Ear Headphones are preferred for portability, but do little about noise cancellation

important. The cushions on the headphones dictate not just the comfort but the noise isolation and the sound quality directly. If you're in a noisy environment with a lot of chatter or background noise, you would be able to hear all that ambient noise if there is no proper seal between the headphone cushions and your ears. In the case of on the ear headphones, this is a problem because they do not completely cover the ear, so you'll be able to hear ambient noise. While some of them may claim to be noise isolating, they might not be effective. On the

ear headphones or Supra-aural headphones are useful when you want to hear the noise around you, such as airline announcements, traffic noise and general office chatter around you. Noise cancelling or isolation is not good in a lot of environments, especially while say, running in a busy environment where you need to hear the honking of the cars around you and the loud calls of the food carts.

Over the Ear

Over the ear headphones or Circumaural headphones do a splendid job of noise isolation. They completely cover the ear and create a good seal which can help you block distractions and outside noise and focus purely on the audio. Most noise cancelling and noise isolating headphones are over the ear and rightly so. These are usually used by professionals who might